Exhibitions

H 1593

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A. Background

Exhibitions are public displays of the work of artists, the skills of performers, products of farms or factories, objects of general or special interest, etc. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for assigning the heading ***Exhibitions*** and the free-floating subdivision ***--Exhibitions***.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Exhibition catalogs***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

For guidelines on place as a theme in art, see H 910. For guidelines on art and fine art, see H 1250. For guidelines on artistic photography, see H 1255. For guidelines on catalogs, see H 1360. For guidelines on illustrations, see H 1659. For guidelines on pictorial works, see H 1935.

B. Recent revisions

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Exhibition: public displays of the work of artists, the skills of performers, products of farms or factories, objects of general or special interest, etc.

Exhibition catalog: publications that document the works displayed in an exhibition[1]

D. General

Assign the heading ***Exhibitions*** (May Subd Geog) to general works on exhibitions and to works that discuss exhibitions collectively in a particular region, country, city, etc.

Do not assign the heading to works about an individual exhibition.

E. Exhibitions on special subjects

E.1. General

Use the free-floating form subdivision ***--Exhibitions*** under any type of heading, including names of persons, classes of persons, ethnic groups, corporate bodies, literary works, place names, disciplines, types of objects, etc., for works on exhibitions about these topics and for individual exhibition catalogs containing descriptions of the exhibition and/or lists of the objects exhibited. For works on exhibitions of objects representing a discipline, use the heading for the objects rather than the discipline, if both headings exist. For works on exhibition techniques and methodology in a specific type of institution, use the topical subdivision ***--Exhibitions*** under the heading for the type of institution, e.g. ***Art museums--Exhibitions***, unless a phrase heading has been established (see sec. F.2, below).

Do not subdivide ***--Exhibitions*** further by ***--Catalogs***.

LC practice: Assign subject heading(s) for the topic of an exhibition. For works on exhibitions of objects representing a discipline, use the heading for the objects rather than the discipline, if both headings exist. Also assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. ***Exhibition catalogs***.

[1] http://vocab.getty.edu/page/aat/300026096

E.2. Phrase headings for exhibitions.

If a phrase heading exists for a special type of exhibition, assign it rather than using a heading of the type ***[topic]--Exhibitions***.

Examples:

650 #0 $a Horticultural exhibitions.
[not 650 #0 $a Gardening $x Exhibitions.]

650 #0 $a Livestock exhibitions
[not 650 #0 $a Livestock $x Exhibitions.]

650 #0 $a Museum exhibits.
[not 650 #0 $a Museums $x Exhibitions.]

E.3. Bibliographical exhibitions.

E.3.a. General

Assign the heading ***Books--History--Exhibitions*** to works on exhibitions that illustrate the history of the book and book arts, including writing, printing, illustrating, collecting and preserving, etc., and to catalogs of individual bibliographical exhibitions of a general nature.

E.3.b. Special subjects

Use the free-floating subdivision ***--Bibliography--Exhibitions*** under any type of heading for works on exhibitions of books, periodicals, etc., about these topics and for individual exhibition catalogs containing descriptions of the exhibition and/or lists of the books displayed.

Do not assign the heading ***Books--History--Exhibitions*** to exhibitions of books on special topics.

LC practice: Assign a subject heading for the topic of the exhibition. Also assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Exhibition catalogs***. See the base instructions under sec E.1.

E.4. Exhibitions held in institutions

Assign the heading ***[name of institution]--Exhibitions*** with the free-floating form subdivision if the objects exhibited are part of the institution's permanent collections. In addition, assign the appropriate headings, as described in sec. E, for the special subject matter of the exhibition.

Do not assign the heading ***[name of institution]--Exhibitions*** if the items displayed are not part of the institution's permanent collections.

LC practice: Assign the name of institution followed by the topical subdivision ***--Exhibitions*** if the objects exhibited are part of the institution's permanent collections.

F. Individual named exhibitions

F.1. General

Assign the name heading for the exhibition to works on individual named exhibitions treated as historical events and to all works on exhibitions without a topical focus to which headings of the type ***[topic]--Exhibitions*** cannot be assigned, such as world's fairs.

Subdivide headings for named exhibitions in accordance with H 1105, if appropriate, including the subdivision ***--Catalogs***.

For historical works on exhibitions with a topical focus, assign additional headings for the subject matter of the exhibition.

For works on the contributions of one country to an international exhibition, assign an additional heading of the type ***[place]--Exhibitions***. If the exhibition has a topical focus, assign appropriate additional headings for the subject matter of the exhibition.

LC practice: Follow the approach described above, except for the instructions related to form subdivisions. Assign the LCGFT ***Catalogs*** in place of the form subdivision ***--Catalogs***, where appropriate. Assign the topical heading or place in combination with the LCGFT ***Exhibition catalogs***. Do not assign both LCGFT ***Catalogs*** and ***Exhibition catalogs***.

F.2. Named exhibitions on special subjects

For guidebooks, catalogs, etc., to individual named exhibitions on special subjects, assign only headings of the type ***[topic]--Exhibitions***.

Do not assign the name heading for the exhibition.

LC practice: Assign the topical heading in combination with the LCGFT ***Exhibition catalogs*** or other appropriate term.

G. Extended examples

Title: Chagall : a comprehensive retrospective.

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600 10 #a Chagall, Marc, $d 1887-1985 $v Exhibitions.
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LC practice:

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600 10 #a Chagall, Marc, $d 1887-1985.
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655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: Shakespeare : an exhibition of books about Shakespeare belonging to the Lehigh University Library.

600 10 #a Shakespeare, William, $d 1564-1616 $v Bibliography $v Exhibitions.

650 #0 $a Rare books $v Bibliography $v Exhibitions.

610 20 $a Lehigh University. $b Library. $b Rare Book Room $v Exhibitions.

LC practice:

600 10 #a Shakespeare, William, $d 1564-1616.

650 #0 $a Rare books.

610 20 $a Lehigh University. $b Library. $b Rare Book Room.

655 #7 $a Bibliographies. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: Somalia in word and image.

651 #0 $a Somalia $x Social life and customs $v Exhibitions.

650 #0 $a Ethnology $z Somalia $v Exhibitions.

650 #0 $a Material culture $z Somalia $v Exhibitions.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a Somalia $x Social life and customs.

650 #0 $a Ethnology $z Somalia.

650 #0 $a Material culture $z Somalia.

655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: The age of Sultan Süleyman the Magnificent.

600 00 $a Süleyman $b I, $c Sultan of the Turks, $d 1494 or 1495-1566 $x Art patronage $v Exhibitions.

650 #0 $a Art, Ottoman $v Exhibitions.

651 #0 $a Turkey $x Civilization $y 16th century $v Exhibitions.

LC practice:

600 00 $a Süleyman $b I, $c Sultan of the Turks, $d 1494 or 1495-1566 $x Art patronage.

650 #0 $a Art, Ottoman.

651 #0 $a Turkey $x Civilization $y 16th century.

655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: Man and animals : the 100th anniversary of the School of Veterinary Medicine.

650 #0 $a Domestic animals $x History $v Exhibitions.

610 20 $a University of Pennsylvania. $b School of Veterinary Medicine $x History $v Exhibitions.

610 20 $a University of Pennsylvania. $b University Museum $v Exhibitions.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Domestic animals $x History.

610 20 $a University of Pennsylvania. $b School of Veterinary Medicine $x History.

610 20 $a University of Pennsylvania. $b University Museum.

655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: The Philadelphia Centennial Exhibition : a catalog.

611 20 $a Centennial Exhibition $d (1876 : $c Philadelphia, Pa.) $v Catalogs.

LC practice:

611 20 $a Centennial Exhibition $d (1876 : $c Philadelphia, Pa.).

655 #7 $a Catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: The complete guide to New York City and the World's Fair.

651 #0 $a New York (N.Y.) $v Guidebooks.

611 20 $a New York World's Fair $d (1964-1965 : $c New York, N.Y.) $v Guidebooks.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a New York (N.Y.).

611 20 $a New York World's Fair $d (1964-1965 : $c New York, N.Y.).

655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft

Revision history

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.